

.NET on Ubuntu — March 2026

Package download statistics for the dotnet/backports PPA on Launchpad.

Reporting period	March 2026 (2026-03-01 to 2026-03-31, UTC)
Data window	2024-04-26 to 2026-07-31
Generated	2026-08-03 00:40:51 UTC
Origin	Backports PPA
Scope	dotnet6, dotnet7, dotnet8, dotnet9, dotnet10 · all Ubuntu series and architectures · debug-symbol packages excluded

At a glance

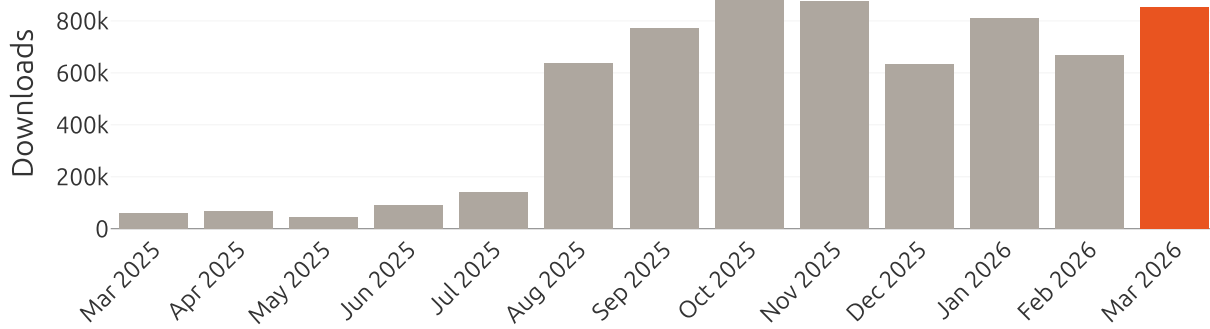
Headline volume and the month's most material movements.

Downloads in month 852,747 vs February 2026: +28.0%	Average per day 27,508 over 31 days with data	Year on year 14× vs March 2025 (59,834)	Peak day 64,739 2026-03-13
Leading version dotnet9 66.9% of the month · 5 active versions	Newest version share 24.5% dotnet10 · +5.5pp	SDK per runtime download 0.67 developer-intent proxy · -10.5%	Lifetime to month end 6,728,651 cumulative since 2024-04-26

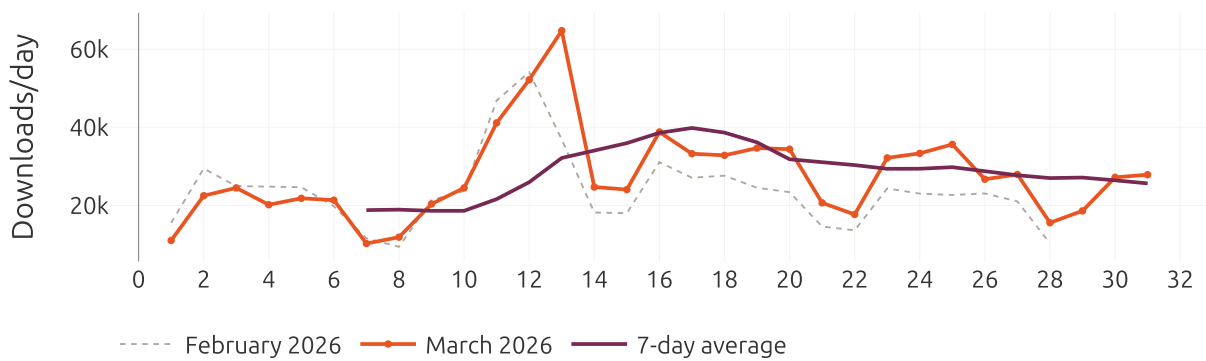
Key findings

Unusual spike on 2026-03-13 (64,739 downloads, 3.2σ above the month's mean) — worth confirming the cause before quoting the monthly total.
852,747 downloads in March 2026 (27,508/day), up +28.0% against February 2026. Year on year the month is 14× higher than March 2025.
Adoption of dotnet10 is accelerating: 24.5% of the month's volume, +5.5pp on February 2026 (+65.3% in absolute terms).
dotnet9 is being displaced: 66.9% of volume, -8.5pp on February 2026 — consistent with migration to newer releases.
dotnet9 remains the most downloaded release at 66.9% of the month, across 5 active .NET versions.
Every runtime-only download came with 0.67 SDK downloads (129,983 SDK vs 195,280 runtime), -10.5% on February 2026 — the mix shifted towards deployment targets.

Monthly downloads, last 13 months



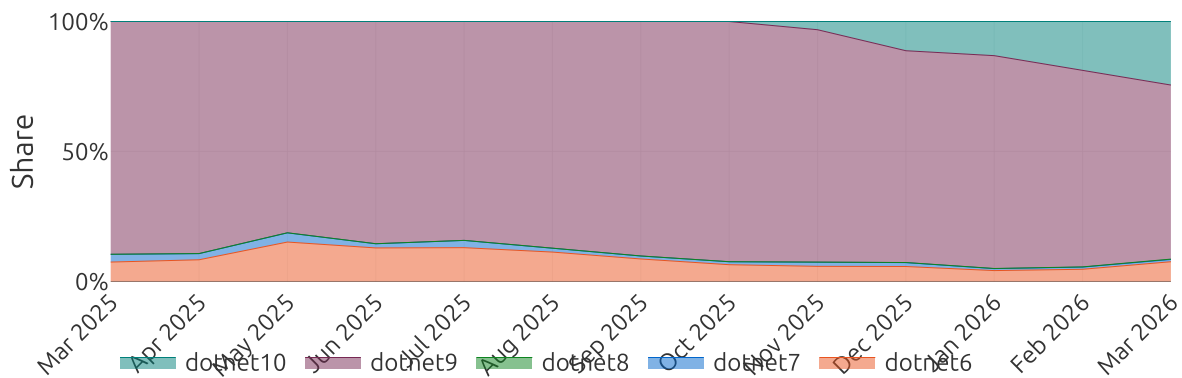
Daily downloads through the month (day of month on x axis)



Composition & adoption

Which .NET releases, Ubuntu series and architectures the downloads came from, and how the mix moved.

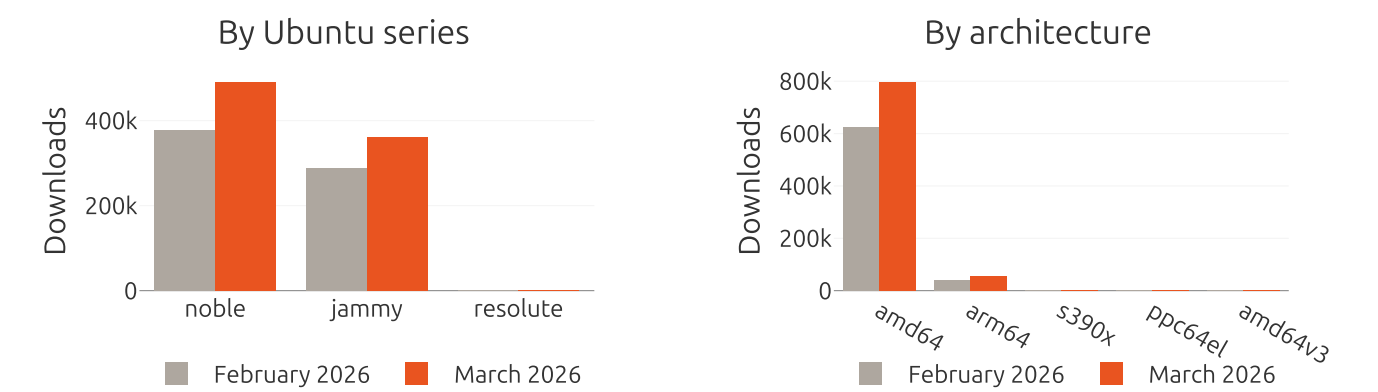
Share of downloads by .NET version



Version detail

VERSION	DOWNLOADS	SHARE	MOM	SHARE CHANGE
dotnet9	570,903	66.9%	+13.6%	-8.5pp
dotnet10	208,527	24.5%	+65.3%	+5.5pp
dotnet6	64,769	7.6%	+107.3%	+2.9pp
dotnet7	7,357	0.9%	+31.9%	+0.0pp
dotnet8	1,191	0.1%	+161.8%	+0.1pp

Share change is in percentage points against February 2026.



Ubuntu series detail

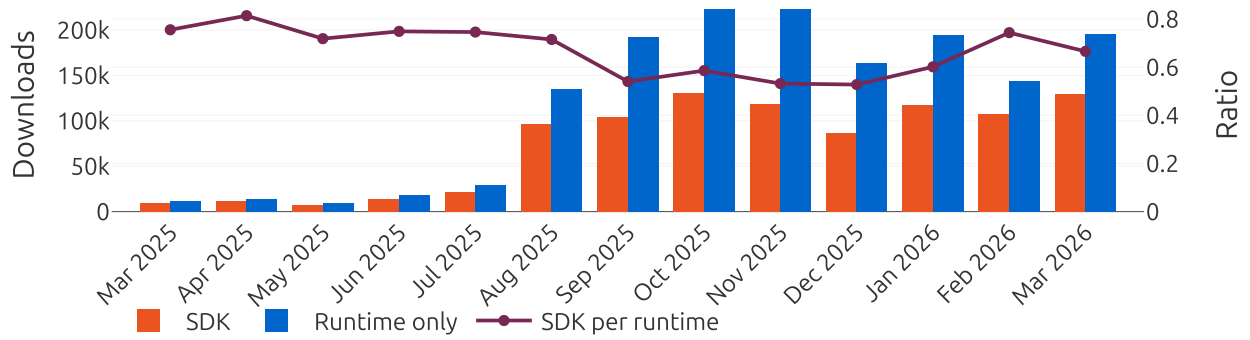
VALUE	DOWNLOADS	SHARE	FEBRUARY 2026	MOM
noble	489,749	57.4%	377,278	+29.8%
jammy	360,710	42.3%	287,761	+25.4%
resolute	2,288	0.3%	962	+137.8%

LTS series (jammy (22.04 LTS), noble (24.04 LTS)) account for 99.7% of the month, -0.1pp on February 2026.

Architecture detail

VALUE	DOWNLOADS	SHARE	FEBRUARY 2026	MOM
amd64	795,088	93.2%	626,294	+27.0%
arm64	56,692	6.6%	39,029	+45.3%
s390x	454	0.1%	301	+50.8%
ppc64el	436	0.1%	329	+32.5%
amd64v3	77	0.0%	48	+60.4%

Developer intent: SDK versus runtime-only downloads



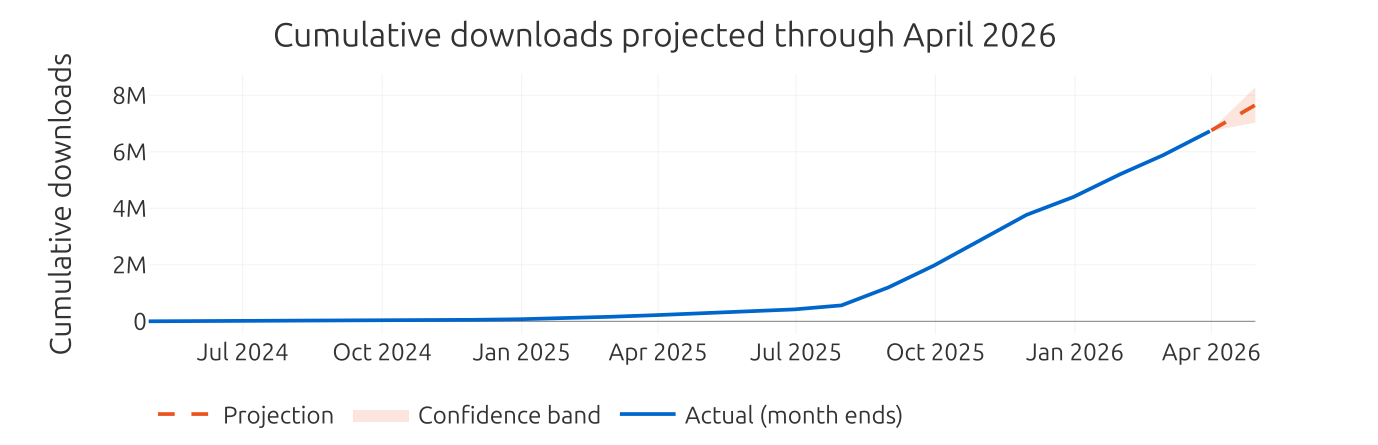
Top packages this month

PACKAGE	TYPE	DOWNLOADS	MOM
dotnet-runtime-9.0	runtime	64,921	+20.1%
dotnet-hostfxr-9.0	hostfxr	64,797	+20.3%
aspnetcore-runtime-9.0	aspnetcore-runtime	63,343	+20.5%
dotnet-host-9.0	host	58,504	+28.1%
aspnetcore-targeting-pack-9.0	targeting-pack	46,531	+7.4%
dotnet-apphost-pack-9.0	apphost-pack	46,442	+7.3%
dotnet-targeting-pack-9.0	targeting-pack	46,351	+7.5%
dotnet-sdk-9.0	sdk	45,424	+8.5%
netstandard-targeting-pack-2.1-9.0	targeting-pack	45,386	+7.3%
dotnet-templates-9.0	other	45,181	+7.5%

SDK downloads indicate development and build environments; runtime-only downloads indicate deployment targets. Neither is a count of people.

Trajectory & watch items

Where the trend is heading, and what needs a human explanation.



Projection fits the daily rate of the 60 days to 2026-03-31 and extrapolates linearly; it assumes no new release events. Indicative total for April 2026: 927,827 downloads.

Momentum by version

VERSION	DOWNLOADS IN MONTH	LAST 7D VS PRIOR 7D	LAST 30D VS PRIOR 30D	TREND (DL/DAY²)	EST. HALF-LIFE
dotnet6	64,769	+5.0%	+93.6%	59.2	growing / stable
dotnet7	7,357	+21.8%	+27.1%	1.2	growing / stable
dotnet8	1,191	+94.1%	+161.8%	0.1	growing / stable
dotnet9	570,903	-16.3%	+7.4%	46.4	growing / stable
dotnet10	208,527	-11.3%	+58.8%	99.2	growing / stable

Windows end on 2026-03-31. Days without data are treated as zero inside these windows, so a collection gap depresses the figures.

Days needing explanation

DATE	DOWNLOADS	ABOVE MONTH MEAN
2026-03-13	64,739	3.2σ
2026-03-12	52,165	2.1σ

Days more than two standard deviations above the month's mean. Common causes are release publications, mirror synchronisation and CI bursts.

Data coverage

MEASURE	VALUE
Days in month	31
Days expected in window	31
Days with download counts	31
Coverage	100.0%
Missing days	0
Gaps	none
Month fully elapsed in dataset	yes
Publications active in month	746
Publications first seen in month	386
Collector last run	2026-07-31

A publication is one binary package version in one series and architecture. A burst of first-seen publications usually follows a release upload or a resumed collection window, not a change in demand.

Methodology & limitations

Figures count package downloads recorded by Launchpad for the dotnet/backports PPA only.

The primary Ubuntu archive publishes no download telemetry, so packages installed from it are not represented here. This report is a directional indicator, not total .NET usage on Ubuntu.

Downloads are not users. CI/CD pipelines, container image builds, mirrors and repeated installations all inflate counts, and one developer may generate many downloads.

Counts are deduplicated per publication and day, keeping the maximum value reported by Launchpad; recent days may still rise as Launchpad reporting settles.

Debug-symbol packages are excluded from every figure in this report.

No data is collected for any other programming language, so this report makes no cross-language comparison.

Source: Launchpad download counts for Backports PPA. Collected by scripts/collect.py; figures reproducible from data/downloads.json for month 2026-03.